

The app you choose doesn't even have to be your own bank's app; interoperability means that you can choose the one that suits you the best. Mutual funds, once thought to be the investment instrument of the elite only, are now available, starting in sachets less than Rs 500 a month. Even gold is being sold digitally!

Technology like IndiaStack has reduced the friction between intent and action to almost zero. It has also meant the removal of unnecessary intermediaries whose commissions are not in line with your needs. Many of the principles in this book can be set up once and forgotten, thanks to where we are today in terms of technology. You can start investing in a completely paperless, presence-less and cashless manner.

But reducing friction is a trick for savings. Technology can also help you nudge your behaviour by increasing friction for areas of spending. There could be apps that ask you to enter two OTPs for that unnecessary e-commerce purchase. Instead of the classic 'upsized', new-age food-ordering apps could prompt you to maybe 'downsize' the fries, saving your health and your money.

Further innovations, like the recently announced account aggregators, will give you a consolidated view of all your finances, helping you track, analyse and better decide how to implement the plan that Monika will shortly arm you with. Especially if you're a first-time investor – it is a truly exciting time. The sophisticated yet simple to use tools available to digital-native investors were never available to us of an earlier generation.

I hope you will enjoy this book and, by the end of it, can talk money both honestly and confidently. By picking up this book you've already taken a great first step. Let me not stand in the way of you and your riches.

Nandan Nilekani